

PayPal Privacy Statement — Analysis

Date Accepted: September 2024

Data Collection Practices

The identifiers collected by PayPal include name, address, phone number, email, IP address, device data, government ID, and signature. Financial/record information includes bank account details, bank routing number, credit card number, CVV, IBAN, annual income, and transaction amount. It also collects account/profile information, data from customer interactions (like chat/call recordings and survey answers), inferential data (including credit worthiness, risk score, shopping behavior), data from sanctions list-related laws, and data that falls under the category of protected classifications (age, citizenship, disabilities when applicable).

Data Sharing Policies

Disclosed to: service providers (AI providers, fraud prevention, bill collection, shipping, payment processing, marketing, compliance/audit, IT/hosting) under contract restricting use to PayPal's purposes; other PayPal corporate-group members; and, per general fintech practice, credit reporting agencies (CRAs) for creditworthiness and fraud checks, PayPal explicitly says CRAs may re-share this data with other organizations for similar checks, a notably broad secondary-sharing acknowledgment not seen in the other 8 policies. PayPal also discloses use of AI/automated decision-making for risk analysis and fraud prevention.

User Rights

Rights described include: right to know / request a copy of personal information; right to request the specific list of third parties data was disclosed to (a stronger, more specific right than most peers offer); right to correct; right to withdraw consent; and right to object to/opt out of profiling from automated decisions with legal or similarly significant effects, though PayPal notes this specific opt-out is largely inapplicable in the US because automated fraud/credit decisions are treated as exempt under current US state laws.

Opt-Out Provisions

Users can manage marketing communication preferences, contact-syncing, and (per the excerpted text) geolocation tracking and account/profile visibility ("Private" profile setting). Non-discrimination is explicitly guaranteed for users who exercise their rights.

Summary

Attribute	Rating
Transparency of collection practices	High (very itemized, especially financial categories)
Sharing disclosure	Medium (clear service-provider language, but CRA re-sharing is a real gap)

Attribute	Rating
User rights clarity	High (specific rights incl. “list of third parties” right)
Opt-out ease	Medium (settings exist but automated-decision opt-out is largely unavailable in the US)
Update transparency	Unverified (source too long to confirm live update-notice practice)